

EMAIL. THE CHANNEL NOBODY CAN TAKE FROM YOU

Capture emails, send great information once or twice a week, soft sell at the bottom, and let your AI do the heavy lifting in your own voice.

BLOG POSTS • SIGNUP FORMS • PLATFORMS • BRAND VOICE • AI

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THE LEAST GLAMOROUS CHANNEL THAT SELLS

Email is the one marketing channel you own. Platforms change their rules, reach drops, and accounts get flagged. Your list stays with you.

This guide shows you how to build a list, what to send, how often, which platform to pick, and how to get your AI to write emails that sound like you.

You do not need to be a writer or a developer. You need to know your customers, care about them, and supervise what your AI sends.

WHAT YOU NEED

A WEBSITE	Where your signup form lives. Any site works.
A BLOG	Your articles become your email content.
AN EMAIL PLATFORM	Most have a free plan to start.
NOTEBOOKLM	Free research on what your customers care about.
AN AI ASSISTANT	AntiGravity, Claude, Grok Bot, or whatever you use.
A BRAND KIT	Logo, colors, fonts, and your voice.

OWN YOUR AUDIENCE

Every platform you post on is rented land. You do not own your followers. You borrow them. An email list is people who raised their hand and said yes, talk to me.

- 1 Know the risk.** A content policy changes, a legal rule shifts, or your account gets flagged, sometimes through no fault of yours. Your page, profile, or community can disappear overnight.
- 2 Know the fix.** With a list, you can always tell people where you went. No platform can shut it down, and it moves with you if you switch email services.
- 3 Blogs find people. Email keeps them.** Blog posts help your SEO and get you recommended by AI search. After that, one of the most important things your website can do is capture emails.
- 4 Aim for 90/10.** About 90% useful content people want, 10% sales. That is what keeps people opening.
- 5 Remember who buys.** People buy your product, but they are also interested in the person behind it. Email is where they get to know you.

"You don't own your followers on another platform. You're borrowing."

THINK OF IT THIS WAY Followers are a crowd walking past your shop. An email list is the people who gave you their address.

TOOLS

EMAIL PLATFORM

WEBSITE

GIVE FIRST

Gary Vaynerchuk's *Jab, Jab, Jab, Right Hook* is about social media, and the same thinking works for email. Jabs are the value you give. The right hook is the ask.

- 1 Give 3, ask 1.** For every email with a hard sell for one product, send 3 packed with information.
- 2 Send what they want to read.** Not what you want to sell. For a fitness brand that meant the latest trends, exercises, superfoods, recipes, and new studies.
- 3 Make yourself interesting.** Be yourself. Tell your story. Make it funny when you can. Nobody wants a list of things you sell.
- 4 Earn the ask.** Giving great stuff does not mean you are owed the sale. It gives you the right to ask every once in a while. Good emails also buy you more leeway when you do ask.
- 5 Run the test.** Would you open this if a stranger sent it? If not, do not send it.

"Would you open it? That's really the test."

SUBJECT LINES Nobody has opened an email titled "Newsletter Issue 14" and felt joy. Make titles interesting, not clickbait.

TOOLS JAB, JAB, JAB, RIGHT HOOK

BLOGS ARE YOUR EMAILS

Every blog article should be good enough to drop into an email. If it is not good enough to email, it is not good enough to publish.

- 1 Research your customers.** Use NotebookLM to find what they care about:

```
Research the customers of my [type of business] in [area]. What problems do they have? What are the most important problems I can solve for them? Suggest article and email topics.
```
- 2 Let AI draft, and you edit.** Your AI can write the articles and the emails. You read every one and only publish what you would read yourself.
- 3 Leak it out slowly.** Do not blast your whole archive in week one. Send 1 article at a time, plus a few extras around it.
- 4 Go local if your business is generic.** Local events, food festivals, seasonal tips. Even a driveway-shoveling business can find reasons to stay remembered in summer.

"Make sure that you care about them."

SHORTCUT The email is the blog post in a nicer shirt. You already did the hard part when you wrote the article.

TOOLS

NOTEBOOKLM

YOUR BLOG

STAY OUT OF SPAM

Boring email gets reported as spam, and spam reports hurt your sender reputation. Good content keeps you in the inbox.

- 1 Watch your spam rate.** Google's sender guidelines: when your messages get reported as spam a lot, future messages are more likely to land in spam. Keep your spam rate under 0.1% and never let it hit 0.3%.
- 2 Only send to people who asked.** And make unsubscribing easy. A clean unsubscribe beats a spam report every time.
- 3 Ask for a reply.** Ask people to add you to their contacts or hit reply. Mail from a contact is less likely to be marked as spam, and you learn what they want.
- 4 Set up SPF, DKIM, and DMARC.** These prove the email really came from your domain. Your email platform walks you through it, or ask your AI to do it with you.
- 5 Do not overload inboxes.** Too many emails in a row gets you unsubscribes or spam reports.

"Good content means fewer spam complaints"

READ Google's email sender guidelines are on the Links and Resources page.

TOOLS

SPF

DKIM

DMARC

GOOGLE SENDER GUIDELINES

HOW OFTEN. WHAT GOES IN.

Once or twice a week, great information at the top, and a soft sell at the bottom, if at all.

- 1 Pick your frequency.** Selling products, twice a week can work. Service business or just starting, once is plenty. Pick a day and keep it.
- 2 Put the gift at the top.** Lead with really good information: the article, a tip, a tool.
- 3 Sell softly at the bottom.** If at all. No countdown timers shouting at people.
- 4 Add a few extras.** A recipe, a tip, a tool you found, a photo from the job site. Whatever your audience cares about.
- 5 Keep it short and scannable.** Mostly point form. People love numbered lists.
- 6 Add images.** Generate them with Grok or any image tool, in your brand style.

"The top of the email is the gift"

FORMAT If an email needs scrolling to find the point, cut it in half.

TOOLS

GROK

IMAGE GENERATOR

PICK A PLATFORM

The best platform is the one you will actually send from. The worst is the one you spend 6 weeks comparing.

- 1 Know the options.** Mailchimp, the one everybody has heard of, with lots of integrations. Kit (formerly ConvertKit), for creators, coaches, and course sellers. Klaviyo, for ecommerce, email plus SMS. Beehiiv, newsletter-first. MailerLite, a simple all-rounder. Brevo, email, SMS, and WhatsApp. All 6 have free plans. Hostinger Reach is built into Hostinger, and its AI writes and designs an email from 1 prompt.
- 2 Match it to your business.** Sell products online: Klaviyo or Mailchimp. Creator or course seller: Kit. Newsletter is the business: Beehiiv. Small business that wants simple: MailerLite, Brevo, or Mailchimp. Already on Hostinger: try Reach.
- 3 Let your AI connect it.** Make an account, then ask your AI to connect the platform to your website and your store. Mailchimp integrates with Shopify, WordPress, and Wix.
- 4 Start free.** Build your first list on a free plan and upgrade when the list earns it.

"You can start off your list for free"

PRICING Plans change. Check the pricing links on the Links and Resources page before you commit.

TOOLS

MAILCHIMP

KIT

KLAVIYO

BEEHIIV

MAILERLITE

BREVO

HOSTINGER REACH

LET YOUR AI WRITE THEM

Make a brand kit first, then connect your AI to it. Now it writes like you, not like a robot that is thrilled to announce things.

- 1 Build the brand kit.** Logo, colors, fonts, your voice, what you would never say, and a few things you wrote that sound like you.
- 2 Teach it your voice.**

Go through my posts on [Facebook / X / my blog] and learn my brand voice. Write it up as a brand voice guide. Then write a sample email in that voice.

If you like how another brand talks, point it at them instead.
- 3 Tell it about your customers.** Who they are, what they want to learn, and what they are sick of hearing.
- 4 Get subject lines.** Ask for a batch, pick the most human one, and write the preview text. Keep it honest. Clickbait gets you opens once and the spam button forever.
- 5 Reinforce what works.**

This is a really good one. I love the way this is done. Take the qualities of this email and keep replicating them.
- 6 Stay the editor.** Supervise every email. If it sounds like a LinkedIn post from 2019, send it back.

"Your brand voice is really important."

DESIGN Your AI can design the email too. Show it one that looks good and say: make it look like this, use my logo.

TOOLS

BRAND KIT

ANTIGRAVITY

CLAUDE

GROK

PUT A CREW ON IT

Grok Bot gives you a team of specialist bots on one subscription. You talk to one chief of staff bot, and it runs the rest.

- 1 Talk to one bot.** Your chief of staff takes your request and hands it to the right specialists: research, design, SEO, web, email, video, accounting, sales.
- 2 Hire specialists by asking.** Need an accountant or a researcher? Ask your chief of staff to set up a new specialist bot. You do not need to know how.
- 3 Create a group for a project.** Ask it to pick the top specialists for a task. The bots discuss it with each other, and you can read along and interrupt.
- 4 Give it the email jobs.** A specialist that writes articles, one that builds emails, one that designs graphics. Hand them your brand kit and brand voice.
- 5 Ignore the jargon.** Orchestrators and agentic loops will not matter soon. Describe what you want in plain words.

"Each bot does its own job."

WHY One place for the whole team, not 9 tabs and a sticky note.

TOOLS

GROK BOT

LEARN FROM THE BEST

Marketing is telling great stories. Study brands that do email well, then show your AI the ones you like.

- 1 **Wealthsimple.** Makes scary money topics simple and fun, and answers the question inside the email.
- 2 **Huckberry.** The content never gets cut from the email: a journal article, photos, a music pick. Some people open just for that, and it builds trust.
- 3 **Morning Brew.** A clear promise, smarter in 5 minutes, delivered every time.
- 4 **The Hustle.** Short, clear, and full of personality.
- 5 **Duolingo.** Not email, but its owl reminders prove a character and a sense of humor can beat a discount code.
- 6 **Really Good Emails.** A huge gallery of real emails. Pick a few and tell your AI:

Make me something like this, in my brand kit.

"That's really what marketing is. It's telling great stories."

REMEMBER The most creative people in the world are the best at hiding their sources.

TOOLS

REALLY GOOD EMAILS

MORNING BREW

THE HUSTLE

ADD A SIGNUP FORM

Put an email signup on your website, even if you run a service company. A roofer's customers want to know when to check their roof before winter. That is an email.

- 1 Ask your AI to build it.** No developer needed:

```
Please add an email signup form to my website that collects names and emails into a database I can send from. Make sure it gets permission and follows the email marketing rules.
```
- 2 Give people a reason.** A useful guide or PDF (your AI can build it), a checklist, a discount, special pricing, access to a community, or simply one good email a week, nothing else.
- 3 Be clear.** Say exactly what they are signing up for. No pre-checked boxes. Every email gets an easy unsubscribe link.
- 4 Follow the law.** US (CAN-SPAM): no misleading subject lines, include your mailing address, honor opt-outs within 10 business days. Canada (CASL): get consent first, identify yourself, include an unsubscribe, act on it within 10 business days.

"Give them a little something for signing up for that list."

NOTE This is not legal advice. Read the CAN-SPAM and CASL guides on the Links and Resources page.

TOOLS

WEBSITE

CAN-SPAM

CASL

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1 Own the channel.** Followers are borrowed. Your list is yours.
- 2 Give first.** 3 emails of real value for every 1 ask.
- 3 Would you open it?** If not, do not send it.
- 4 Blog posts are email content.** Write once, send slowly.
- 5 Protect your inbox placement.** Spam rate under 0.1%, easy unsubscribe, and SPF, DKIM, and DMARC set up.
- 6 Once or twice a week.** The gift at the top, a soft sell at the bottom, if at all.
- 7 Pick a platform and send.** The one you will use beats the one you compare for 6 weeks.
- 8 Brand kit first.** Then let your AI write in your voice, and edit everything.
- 9 Capture emails.** A signup form with a real reason to join, done legally.

TOOLS

MAILCHIMP	Well-known all-rounder with lots of integrations. Free plan.
KIT	For creators, coaches, and course sellers. Free plan.
KLAVIYO	Ecommerce email plus SMS. Free plan.
BEEHIIV	Newsletter-first. Free plan.
MAILERLITE	Simple all-rounder for small businesses. Free plan.
BREVO	Email, SMS, and WhatsApp in one. Free plan.
HOSTINGER REACH	Email inside Hostinger. AI writes and designs from 1 prompt.
NOTEBOOKLM	Research what your customers care about.
GROK BOT	A team of specialist bots run by one chief of staff.
GROK	Images for your emails.
REALLY GOOD EMAILS	Gallery of real emails to learn from.
SPF / DKIM / DMARC	Domain settings that prove your email is really from you.
PIXABAY MUSIC	Copyright-free music for videos and lives.

LINKS AND RESOURCES

ANTIHERO AI GROUP	facebook.com/groups/antiheroai
JAB, JAB, JAB, RIGHT HOOK	harpercollins.com/products/jab-jab-jab-right-hook-gary-vaynerchuk
GARY ON JABS AND HOOKS	garyvaynerchuk.com/the-one-thing-i-didnt-clarify-enough-in-jab-jab-jab-right-hook
GOOGLE SENDER GUIDELINES	support.google.com/a/answer/81126
CAN-SPAM GUIDE (FTC)	ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/can-spam-act-compliance-guide-business
CASL	ised-isde.canada.ca/site/canada-anti-spam-legislation/en
CASL CONSENT	ised-isde.canada.ca/site/canada-anti-spam-legislation/en/getting-consent-send-email
MAILCHIMP	mailchimp.com/pricing/marketing
KIT	kit.com/pricing
KLAVIYO	klaviyo.com/pricing
BEEHIIV	beehiiv.com/pricing
MAILERLITE	mailerlite.com/pricing
BREVO	brevo.com/pricing
HOSTINGER REACH	hostinger.com/email-marketing
WEALTHSIMPLE TLDR	reallygoodemails.com/emails/wealthsimple-tldr-newsletter-welcome-email
WEALTHSIMPLE, EMAIL LOVE	emaillove.com/wealthsimples-mortgage-rates-coming-down
HUCKBERRY ON EMAILS	glossy.co/fashion/huckberrys-head-of-marketing-ben-omeara-on-writing-product-emails-people-actually-want-to-read
MORNING BREW	morningbrew.com
THE HUSTLE	thehustle.co
DUOLINGO CEO TED TALK	ted.com/talks/ luis_von_ahn_how_to_make_learning_as_addictive_as_social_media
REALLY GOOD EMAILS	reallygoodemails.com
NOTEBOOKLM	notebooklm.google.com
PIXABAY MUSIC	pixabay.com/music

MORE LINKS • FILL IN

ACTION STEPS

-
- ☐ **01 PICK A PLATFORM TODAY**
Use the match list in Step 6 and open a free account.

 - ☐ **02 ADD A SIGNUP FORM**
Ask your AI to build it with permission, a clear promise, and no pre-checked boxes.

 - ☐ **03 MAKE A REASON TO JOIN**
A guide, checklist, discount, or one good email a week.

 - ☐ **04 SET UP SPF, DKIM, AND DMARC**
Follow your platform's steps or ask your AI to walk you through them.

 - ☐ **05 BUILD YOUR BRAND KIT AND VOICE**
Logo, colors, fonts, and a voice guide your AI writes from your own posts.

 - ☐ **06 RESEARCH YOUR CUSTOMERS**
Run the NotebookLM prompt and list 10 email topics.

 - ☐ **07 TURN 1 BLOG POST INTO AN EMAIL**
Gift at the top, 1 or 2 extras, and a soft ask at the bottom, if any.

 - ☐ **08 WRITE HONEST SUBJECT LINES**
Ask for a batch, pick the most human one, and add preview text.

 - ☐ **09 PICK A SEND DAY**
Once a week to start. Keep it.

 - ☐ **10 POST IT IN THE GROUP**
Share your first email or your signup form for real feedback.

POST YOUR FIRST EMAIL IN THE GROUP BE YOUR OWN HERO

Share your first email or your signup form in the group.
You will get real feedback. Nice, but real.

[FACEBOOK.COM/GROUPS/ANTIHEROAI](https://facebook.com/groups/antiheroai)

